



RIVER RAGA A sunset cruise featuring a classical music performance; SAF curators Bickram Ghosh and Geeta Chandran

Usha Uthup, Aruna Sairam, and Runa Laila; 'Come Eat With Me', an interdisciplinary theatre performance that delves into the complex relationship between caste and food; and 'Glitch in the Myth', a theatrical performance which reinterprets the Ramayana from the perspective of a young woman. With 200-plus projects, each with several layers of micro-programming, there's no way someone can experience the entire festival. "One of the things we are trying to do is force people to make decisions," says Munjal.

Next year, SAF will also go international; from May 23 to June 1, 2025, the festival travels to Birmingham, UK. But that's not big enough for Munjal. His dream project is 'The Brij'. Coming up in Delhi's Vasant Kunj, the 'live museum' will comprise a million sq. ft of experiential spaces and will bridge multiple art forms, cultures and peoples. "It's what we do at Serendipity to the power of 100. All the stuff we do once a year will happen there every day, all year long," says Munjal. The name? A subtle nod to Munjal's father and his legacy. Serendipitous, isn't it? ■

–Amit Dixit

FESTIVAL

LOVE LETTER TO THE MOUNTAINS

'Journeying Across the Himalayas' is a new multidisciplinary festival in Delhi with a focus on the Himalayan region and its communities

For Indian motorcycling giant Royal Enfield, the Himalayas have been a spiritual home. Over the last 75 years, they have fostered a deep relationship with the region and its people. After steering a few popular sustainability initiatives in the Himalayas, the Royal Enfield Social Mission has announced the inaugural edition of the 'Journeying Across the Himalayas' festival from December 5-15, 2024, at Travancore Palace in New Delhi. The thought behind this one-of-a-kind event is to offer an opportunity for visitors to discover the region's unique landscape, crafts, culture, food and people.

"We've been on this journey for a few years now. Our vision is to empower over 100 Himalayan communities while building resilience against climate change. Alongside, we are going to catalyse a global movement of one million riders who will become agents of change in the region," says Bidisha Dey, executive director of Eicher Group Foundation. "We feel the fragile Himalayan ecosystem must be preserved."

The event offers interactive installations and exhibitions that delve into diverse cultural practices and conservation efforts. For instance, 'An Ode to the Snow Leopard', a VR film by filmmakers Gautam Pandey and Doel Trivedy, transports viewers to the remote high-altitude habitats of the elusive snow leopard.

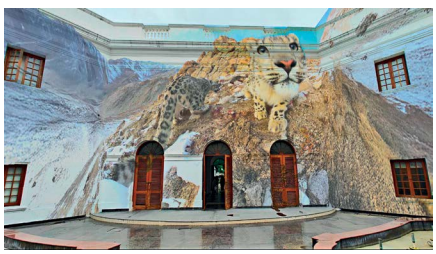
Similarly, the exhibit 'Helmets for India, Art for Change', in partnership with India Foundation for the Arts, features works of 12 artists using helmets as a canvas, and is an unconventional way to reinforce a critical message—road safety.

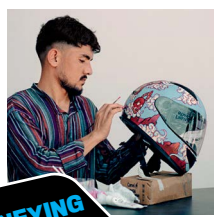
There will be workshops and discussions, culinary experiences, curated festival shops and cultural performances to drive home the message of sustainability, but in a more palatable format. Besides, From Folk to Fabric: The Himalayan Knot Textile Exhibition will bring together Himalayan artisan communities, conservation specialists, craftspeople and designers to conserve pastoral lands and spotlight craft practices. Festival-goers can also participate in engaging discussions around textile conservation, intangible cultural heritage, responsible tourism and the like. ■

–Geetika Sachdev



SHUBHAM LODHA





RAREFIED AIR (From top clockwise) Projection mapping of 'An Ode to the Snow Leopard'; "Helmets for India..."; Changpa women of Ladakh weaving sheep wool

'JOURNEYING ACROSS THE HIMALAYAS' will be on from Dec. 5-15 at the Travancore Palace, Delhi